

If humanity is moving and must move toward a single society as a result of technological developments, then what is the role of the individual if the whole concept of individualism is not to degenerate into cynical, sybaritic privatism or to be dismissed as an anachronism? The question is not unimportant. It merits the careful attention of savants such as Aron, but it also demands their most thoughtful and searching probing. In Aron's attempt there is little progress and much disillusion as results of insufficient consideration of the range and requirements of attempting an answer.

G. S. CESARI*

Innovation Diffusion as a Spatial Process. By Torsten Hägerstrand. Translation and postscript by Allan Pred. Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1968. Pp. xvi+334. \$16.00.

The dean of spatial-diffusion simulation research finally breaks out of his linguistic isolation! It is indeed ironic that various research traditions on diffusion have not diffused their methods and findings to each other. So, for example, students of agricultural innovation diffusion were for years unaware of the considerable work, with amazingly similar results, of those studying educational diffusion. These disciplinary curtains are beginning to rise in the mid-1960's, and researchers of the diffusion of innovations are emerging as a relatively integrated community of scholars.

A heartening step in this direction is represented by the present volume. Professor Hägerstrand's book first was published in Swedish in 1953, and his novel approach to the simulation of innovation diffusion has since had a considerable impact on research by a small coterie of quantitative geographers in the United States. But linguistic barriers have severely retarded the widespread diffusion of Hägerstrand's approach; it was not until 1965 that his first work was published in English as a journal article (although his ideas in mimeographed form had enjoyed a considerable "subterranean circulation" among some U.S. academics since 1962). Now, finally, we have a detailed treatment of Hägerstrand's ingenious approach.

But there are still important barriers, even though the problem of language is overcome. One barrier is the price. Another is the weighty (but impressively detailed) nature of Hägerstrand's prose. One must plod through the maddening minutiae of maps, data, and description before the main dimensions of the author's method seem to emerge. In fact, much is added to the reader's comprehension by translator Allan

* MR. CESARI is dean of Bennett College, Millbrook, New York.